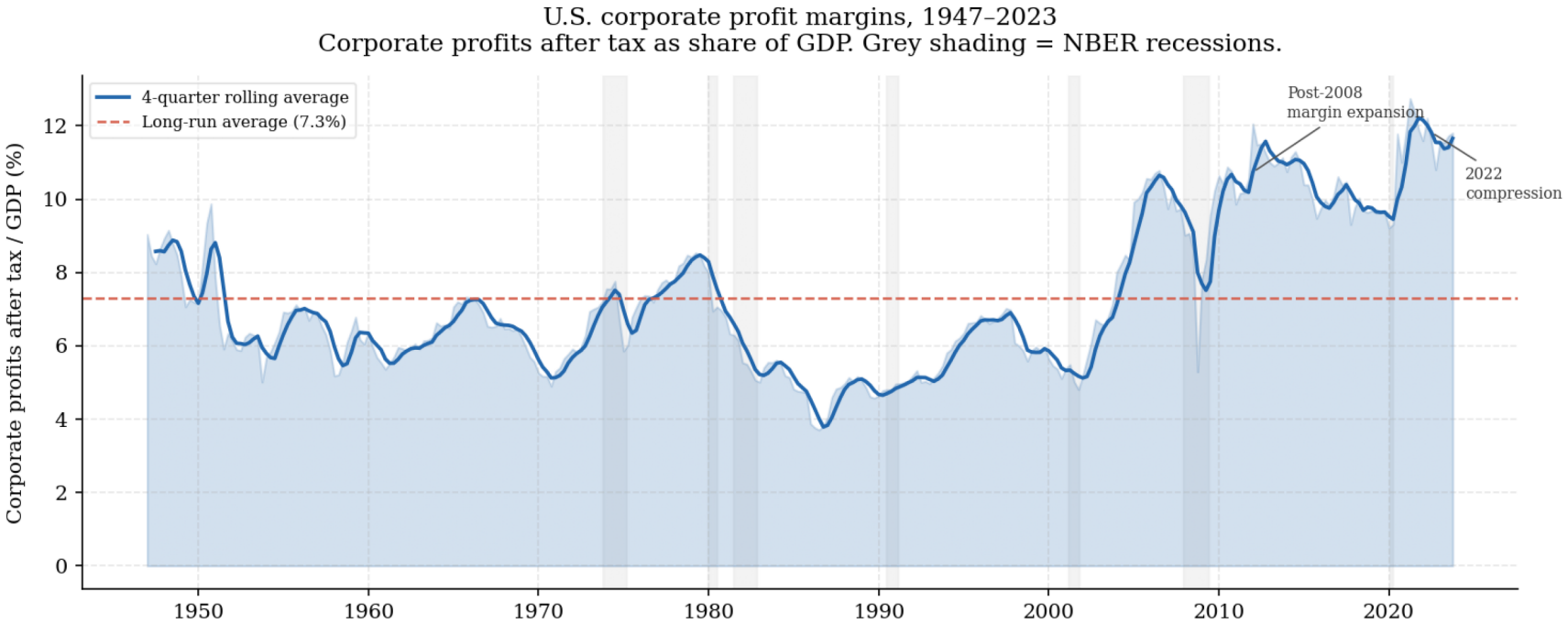
U.S. corporate profit margins, 1947–2023
Corporate profits after tax as share of GDP. Grey shading = NBER recessions.
4-quarter rolling average
Long-run average (7.3%)
Post-2008
margin expansion
2022
compression
Corporate profits after tax / GDP (%)
0
2
4
6
8
10
12
1950
1960
1970
1980
1990
2000
2010
2020